Breathless but Calm

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at https://archiveofourown.org/works/77794221.

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Teen And Up Audiences

Archive Warning:
No Archive Warnings Apply

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F/F

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

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Breathless but Calm

by Lisra

Summary

My first songfic. Adora goes to a party only because she knows Catra is there. She doesn't really have a plan, just hopes.

Can you guess The song?

Notes

See the end of the work for notes

Adora takes a deep breath and another one for good luck, before walking through the garden gate. Music drifts through the night air up the gloomy path. The mansion by the lake by contrast is lit up like a beacon. She stops and checks her Nokia again. No further message, which means Catra has made it. An entire battalion of butterflies invades her stomach. The way from the gate to the house is illuminated with strings of colored lights and lanterns. The bushes and trees loom like monstrous black shapes behind them. If the music emanating from the house wasn't skate punk it would have been unsettling. The door stands wide open. Beyond the threshold paradise and purgatory are very close together for Adora Grey and only the presence of someone she thinks is perfect makes the difference.

And then suddenly Adora is inside , forcing herself past people milling around with their stupid red cups in their hands, nodding their heads to the music and staring at one another, and especially at everyone coming in through the door.

"Yo Grey, what are you doing here?"

"Nice legs, Blondie!"

"Who invited *her?"*

Adora ignores all of them, but her right hand flies down to the black pleated skirt she has decided to wear, as if she needs to keep it in place. *Of course* that's all everyone sees, the swimmer with her legs bare. Adora wishes she owned fishnets or something.

Somewhere inside is her friend Grace, who and the others call Glimmer, perhaps holding court like a queen, or perhaps trying to keep things together. Adora does not look around to find out. She has only one high, high hope for this night.

The main room has been mostly emptied out and serves as the main dance floor. Mismatched disco balls hang from the ceiling, but the lights are kept low. Adora hesitates for an entire chorus of

The Impression That I Get but then she sports Catra leaning against a wall and her heart quickens. She weaves through the throng of sweating teenagers as if it was a time trial at the pool. When Catra spots coming closer, her eyes light up, her ears swivel and her tail uncoils. She yells something that Adora can't hear, but then she is up close to her and Adora suddenly can't concentrate. They dance next to one another, since it's impossible to do anything else. Adora keeps catching glimpses of Catra. She'd never wear a skirt like Adora dared to tonight, but she has put on *very* short shorts and a winged logo tank top identical to hers. It hugs her figure in the way that makes Adora breathless in class. She only sees one set of straps. *She's got nothing underneath?* She wonders and controls her breathing. *I'm doing fine. We're doing fine*.

The song changes and Catra drops her hands on Adora's shoulders, then slides them down her arms. She's very close, closer than she has ever been to her in public. If a dark room full of dancers is public. Their legs graze, Adora's swimmer smooth and Catra's soft fur. *We're doing fine.* Adora locks her hands on Catra's back. *We're doing nothing at all.*

They dance slowly and the straightest slow-dance ballad becomes queer for them. Adora sinks into Catra and her gentle movements. This is something she had hoped for, wished for with the frantic urgency of youth that feels like it could tear a hole into her chest some nights. It drags wild thoughts in its wake. Soon they'll graduate. Who knows what happens next. What would happen if more people found out. If they came out, for real, not just in people's heads in a way that made them whisper, point and yell. They could be dead soon. Adora knows they have time. It feels like they have no time at all. They aren't even together yet. Not really. Only mostly. Likely. Probably.

The song ends and Catra takes one of Adora's hands. *No*, she feels, she palms her something. Then she winks at her, conspiratorially, devilishly, and pushes past her, towards the other end of the room where it eventually opens up to a patio area.

Adora stands there, abandoned with a crumpled paper note in her hand. Without hesitation she runs for the bathroom.

She washes her hands twice, splashes her face three times and then reads the note for a fourth time.

This party sucks. Meet me at the boat shed. I picked the lock.

-C

This party does suck! Adora smiles, no, she grins from ear to ear. This sounds like a much better idea. She checks herself for a final time and then leaves the bathroom. Her grin must travel before her, because before she can bow out, some jeers.

"Hey Grey, did you get some?"

Adora huffs. At other times there would have been a fight. But she's got better things to do now. She's got a *date*. Sort of.

She slips out of the house and into the darkness between the trees, hoping that there are no stinging nettles and that all biting insects are asleep already.

The lake is a forbidding dark shape and the path is hardly visible but Adora finds her way down. The boat shed isn't so much a shed as it is a separate house. Adora has never been down here.

"There you are," a familiar voice hisses from the shadows and Adora jumps.

"Catra!"

"Hey, Adora," Catra fucking *purrs* at her, "won't you come in?"

Carefully Adora enters the building and when Catra closes the door behind her, she can barely see. But she feels Catra's arms around her and her warm breath on her neck.

Litte shit, Adora thinks, but fondly. She pushes her ass back into Catra and gets the sharp intake of breath she counted on.

"Is this it and if so did you bring a blanket?" she asks as her eyes adjust somewhat. It is still very dark, but she can make up that they are in a sort of bar area. That large object further back is either a dining or a pool table.

"Something a lot better. Come on."

"I kinda like this," Adora replies and wiggles her butt, "and I can't see."

"Ah, I accounted for you sorry human eyes. I brought a flashlight. Can't risk turning the lights on, can we."

Adora huffs.

"You like my eyes."

Suddenly Catra is in front of her.

"No, I *love* your eyes. Now take this and follow me."

With the aid of the small light Catra takes Adora through the bar, through a corridor and up a flight of stairs.

"I think this is some sort of guest bedroom", Catra says hesitatingly. *Bed*. Adora's thoughts rush. A bed, for them, far away, or at least far enough, from prying eyes.

She can see her outlined in the doorway, her tail flicking nervously. Adora gives her a smile and laces their fingers together. She pulls her inside and closes the door with a foot.

They stand in the strange bedroom on a thick carpet that smells a bit of dust and damp, but the only thing that matters is that they look into one another's eyes.

“Pity it’s so dark, even for me,” Catra says, very close to her, “I love that skirt on you.”

Adora swallows. But they are already here. She chases her hope, because who knows, she might be dead soon and she’d prefer dying happy. She’d prefer not to die at all.

“I’d rather hope you’d take it off,” she whispers and Catra *trills.* Her hands are under the skirt, making her breath hitch.

“You look so hot,” Adora adds. Unasked and unanswered questions hang around them, but they fade into insignificance. They know why they are here. They know they are in love. They either need to say it, or to show it.

“Shut up, Catra whispers, and deciding to show it, kisses her and Adora opens her lips to her and they try to walk sideways towards the bed, but that’s tricky when you’re kissing and trying to feel your love up and so they really crash on the bed, tangled limbs and harmless bruises and all.

They laugh until their sides hurt. Then they lie next to one another, their bare legs entangled.

“You know what someone asked me on my way here?” Adora asks.

Catra shakes her head. “No?”

“*Hey did you get some?”*

Catra laughs and buries her head in Adora’s shoulder. She has always loved the pressure from Catra’s body next to her, and has done so for years. It somehow led to this.

Catra raises her head suddenly.

“We have to stay quiet,” she says, her voice.

“Why? Someone coming?”

Catra moves and then Adora feels one hand at her chin and another gently pushing up her skirt.

"So we can get some."

They kiss again. Their longest yet. Adora's heart is so full it feels like it could burst.

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Adora vividly remembered that night for many, many years. Every little details that she could. So many little touches and noises, because she couldn't see much, most of all the little noises Catra made under her fingers and that she in return coaxed out of Adora, and the smells and the sensations big and small.

And then they see the dim fluorescent numbers of the radio clock proclaim that it's now 3am and they should hurry. Adora is grateful that it's summer and that putting on underwear, skirt and a tank top takes less time than tying her shoes.

They sneak out of the guest house and from the property, avoiding all eyes. The foliage is damp from a spell of rain that had made a pleasant background noise. Whoever is left at the party is either busy like they had been, or too drunk to care. From afar it looks like a marvel that the cops weren't called.

Adora and Catra walk hand in hand down the empty wet streets. No car or other person is around. They don't talk much, just walk, their limbs heavy with exhaustion. They simply exist together, sharing the time and space. *Whatever hopes I had*, Adora thinks, *hadn't been high enough*. This is more, she just knows it.

The gate to Catra's neighborhood is locked. She hisses at the metal bars but Adora just grins. Making sure Catra can get a good look up her skirt, she climbs the gate in a few seconds and then opens it from the inside.

"Show off," Catra mutters, but her eyes are lit up.

At the house where, hopefully, her parents are asleep and none the wiser, they stop. Catra's parents aren't… *bad*… not bad in the way Adora's first set of foster parents had been, but she has no idea how they will react when they eventually get told or find out. Catra turns to Adora and puts her hands on her waist. Adora shifts into the touch.

"You," whispers Catra, "are my girlfriend if you want to be, Adora, and I will stand by you, because… because of more things than I can say right now."

Adora smiles at her. The streetlights make Catra's eyes shine and they are to her the most beautiful things she has ever seen.

"Then you are my girlfriend and I am yours," she whispers back, "and I love you."

Catra swallows, and tears of overwhelming emotion prick at her eyes. She leans forward, hands on Adora's waist and kisses her again, long and deep. She may not find more words, but Adora knows that she means it; means it just like she does.

End Notes

The Song is...

This! and I wish there was like a version that is more gay, but there we are. Hope you enjoyed it, I didn't plan anything or had it beta read, just wrote it down because I felt like it. See you soon with something more planned!

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!